

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

LAB 08 INSTRUCTIONS

For

Sort the HR Inbox and Draft One Reply

Course Code: C197

Conducted by

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

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Version 3.0

Lab 8 — Sort the HR Inbox and Draft One Reply

Topic 04 · Staff Questions, Repeatable Work and Advanced Claude · approximately 20 minutes

Where the files for this lab are

Every file this lab needs is inside one folder that came with your course materials. Open the labs folder, then open this folder inside it:

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labs/lab-08-sort-the-hr-inbox-and-draft-one-reply/
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Do not look in any other lab folder. This lab is self-contained.

Files you will use, and what the steps call them

The steps below refer to these items in plain English. Use this table to find the exact file to open, and the exact sheet tab to click at the bottom of the Excel window.

The steps call it	App	Open this file	Then click
The workbook you complete in this lab	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx	opens on the first tab
The summary view	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx	the "Summary" tab
How this workbook is organised — read this tab first	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx	the "Read_Me" tab
The staff messages you sort	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx	the "Staff_Messages" tab
Where staff information is kept	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx	the "Where_Info_Is_Kept" tab
The review log — where you record who checked the work	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx	the "Review_Log" tab

Goal

Work through a set of fictional staff messages held in a local workbook. Claude sorts them by what each one needs and drafts one reply. Then the Microsoft 365 connector turns that reply into a real Outlook draft — which you review and send yourself.

What you will produce

Every message sorted, one reply drafted, the person who would approve it named, and the reply created as an Outlook draft ready for review.

Before you start

- Excel installed, with the Claude panel available from the ribbon.
- Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx from this folder.
- No mailbox, no Outlook and no work account are required. Nothing in this lab is sent.

Steps

Follow these in order. Where a shaded block appears, type or paste it exactly as shown into Claude, then read what Claude proposes before you accept anything.

1. Open Lumina-Living-Lab-08-Staff-Questions.xlsx from this lab folder and click the Staff_Messages tab. These are fictional messages from Lumina Living staff. Everything here is local; you will not open Outlook and nothing is ever sent.
2. Open the Claude panel in Excel and ask Claude to sort the messages. Read the answer on screen.

Prompt to type into Claude:

Read the messages on the Staff_Messages sheet in this open workbook. Sort them into four groups: needs a reply from HR today, needs a decision from someone else, is just information, and needs nothing. Give your reason and say which Message_ID you mean for each one. Do not change the sheet.

3. In the Action column of the Staff_Messages tab, write the group you agree with for each message.
4. Pick one message that needs a reply and ask Claude to draft it. Read the draft on screen.

Prompt to type into Claude:

Draft a short reply to the message I have selected on the Staff_Messages sheet. Use only what that message and this workbook actually say. Keep it under 120 words, say clearly what happens next and who is doing it, and write 'need to check' rather than inventing any date, amount or entitlement. Show me the draft. Do not send anything and do not change the workbook.

5. Now put the reply into Outlook. Open Claude Desktop, where you connected Microsoft 365 in Lab 0, and ask it to create the draft. It creates a draft only — nothing is sent, and you are still the one who presses Send. If your connector is not available, record it and read the draft you wrote in Excel instead; the approval lesson is the same.

Prompt to type into Claude:

Using the Microsoft 365 connector, create a draft reply in Outlook to the message I chose on the Staff_Messages sheet.

Use the reply I wrote in the Draft_Reply column, exactly as it stands. Do not reword it. Address it to the sender of that message only. Use the original subject with 'Re:' in front.

Create it as a draft. Do not send it. Tell me where to find it when you are done.

Check your work

Every message has an answer in the Action column, one reply under 120 words is written in the Draft_Reply column, its approver is named, and the reply exists as an unsent draft in Outlook or the connector state is recorded. Nothing was sent.

If something goes wrong

- **You expected to open Outlook to read the messages.** The messages are in the workbook so the lab runs on any computer. Outlook is used only at the end, to create the draft.
- **The connector is not available.** Record it and stop at the Excel draft. Every earlier step works without Outlook.
- **Claude reworded my reply.** Ask again and say 'use the text exactly as it stands, do not reword'. The point is that you approve the words, not Claude.
- **Claude sent the message.** It should not. The prompt says create a draft and do not send. If it sent, report it and check the recipient immediately.
- **Claude invents a figure or a date.** Re-run the prompt; it instructs Claude to write 'need to check' instead of inventing.

Challenge

Create an escalation rule for messages that contain a financial commitment, legal interpretation or personal data.

Reflection

Which part of email handling should remain human even if drafting becomes nearly automatic?